GRE Vocabulary Tracker & Spaced-Revision Calendar

Etymological Root Deconstructions, Leitner 5-Box Spaced Repetition, Secondary Meaning Registers & Error Logs

1. High-Yield Greek & Latin Roots: 10 Roots = 100+ GRE Words

Mastering root families enables intuitive decoding of unfamiliar words on Text Completion & Sentence Equivalence.

Root Morpheme	Core Etymological Meaning	Sample High-Frequency	Contextual Usage Note
BELL / BELLI	War, aggression, fight	Bellicose, belligerent, antebellum, rebellion	Signals hostile tone in TC contrasting clauses
CAP / CIP / CEPT	Take, seize, hold	Incipient, captious, precipitate, percipient	Captious means fault-finding (not captivating)
LUC / LUM / LUX	Light, clarity, shine	Lucid, pellucid, elucidate, luminary	Pellucid is high-frequency GRE for crystal clear
MUT	Change, alter	Immutable, commute, mutable, transmute	Immutable is frequently paired with perennial / static
PUG / PUGN	Fight, fist, conflict	Pugnacious, repugnant, impugn, pugilist	Impugn means to challenge the integrity of
VER	True, truth, real	Veracious, verisimilitude, aver, verify	Caution: Veracious (truthful) vs Voracious (hungry)

STRATEGIC PRINCIPLE: Technique: Group vocabulary into semantic thematic clusters (e.g., Praise vs Slander, Brevity vs Verbosity).

2. The 30-Day Spaced Repetition (Leitner) Schedule

Active recall calendar preventing the standard 80% Ebbinghaus forgetting curve.

Study Day	New Words Acquired	Review Phase (Active Recall)	Application Practice
Days 1 - 5	25 words/day (125 total)	Same-day evening active recall test	Write 5 original compound sentences using new roots
Days 6 - 7	Review Box 1 words	Test Days 1-5 cards; move correct to Box 2	Solve 15 official ETS Text Completion questions
Days 8 - 14	25 words/day (175 new)	Daily review of Box 1; 3-day review Box 2	Complete 20 Sentence Equivalence paired-synonym drills
Days 15 - 21	20 words/day (140 new)	Weekly review Box 2; Move 2-week cards to Box 3	Identify secondary definitions (e.g. qualify, plastic, table)
Days 22 - 30	Consolidation & Mocks	Review Box 3 & 4; Target persistent errors	Timed 20-question Verbal sections under exam conditions

STRATEGIC PRINCIPLE: Vocabulary Target: Aim for 700 to 900 high-frequency words; quality of contextual understanding trumps 3,000 rote words.

3. The Secondary Meaning Trap Alert: Words With Double Lives

ETS loves using everyday words in their rare academic, archaic, or secondary senses.

- Qualify: In GRE context, means to limit or restrict a statement (not just to meet requirements).
- Plastic / Plasticity: Means malleable, adaptable, easily molded (not synthetic petroleum material).
- Table: As a verb in US English, means to postpone consideration; in UK English, to propose for debate.
- Pedestrian: Means dull, ordinary, lacking imagination (not someone walking on the sidewalk).
- Belie: Means to give a false impression of, or to contradict (often serves as a structural pivot word in TC).